

UNIT 1

CHARACTERISTICS OF LIVING THINGS

Learning objectives:

- Understand what living things are with examples.
- Understand the signs or characteristics of life.

There are many things around us. Some of them have **life**, such as birds, animals, plants, and humans. They are called **living things**.

Examples of living things include:



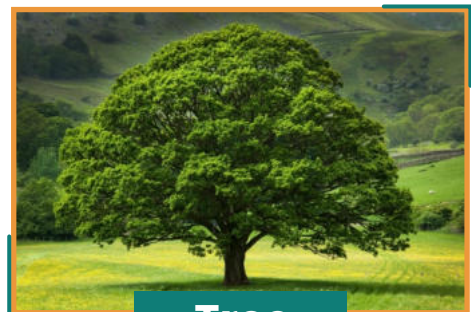
Parrot



Elephant



Man



Tree

Now, what do we call things without life?

They are called **non-living things**, such as pencils, cups, brushes, stones, etc.

How do we know if something is **living** or **non-living**?

To understand this **difference**, we need to know the **signs** or **characteristics** of life. There are **six signs** of life that define living things. Let's read them out loud!

1. All Living things **need food and water**.

2. All Living things **move**.

3. All living things **grow**.

4. All living things **breathe**.

5. All living things **have senses**.

6. All living things **reproduce**.



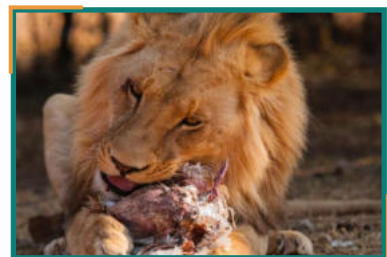
Signs or Characteristics of Life

1) All Living Things Need Food and Water:

- All living things **eat food** and **drink water** to survive.
- They get **energy** from food and water.
- Humans get food from plants and animals.
- Animals get food from plants and other animals.

Example:

- A lizard eats insects.
- A goat eats grass.
- A lion eats goats.



Plants do not eat other living things like humans and animals do. Plants **make their own food** using **sunlight**, **water** and **air**.

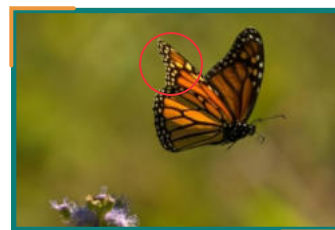
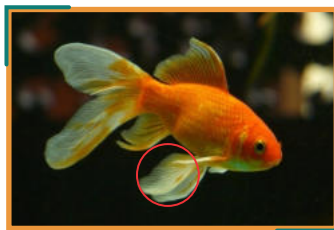
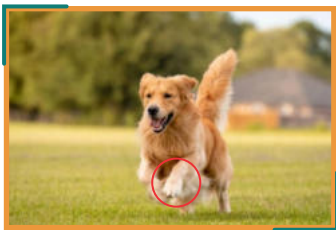


2) All Living Things Move:

Living things move from **one place to another** to find **food** and **shelter**.

For example:

- A **dog** runs with the help of legs.
- A **fish** swims with the help of fins.
- A **butterfly** flies with the help of wings.



- Humans use their **hands and legs** to walk, run, and do other activities.



- Plants do not move like humans and animals do but they can **move their parts** to perform **different functions**.

For example:

- Opening and closing of flowers.

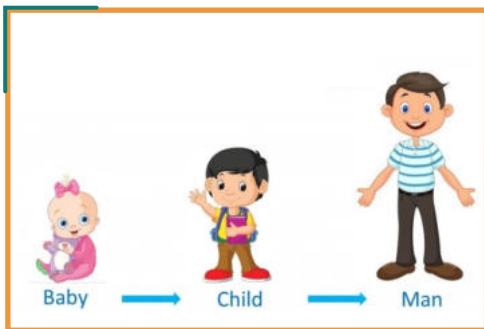


- Roots move by growing towards water in the ground.



3) All Living Things Grow:

- All living things grow.
- Humans and animals are born as babies and grow as they get older.
- Plants grow from seeds in the ground.



DO YOU KNOW?

Living things do not live forever. All humans, animals and plants die at some point.



4) All Living Things Breathe:

All living things breathe air to survive.

For example :

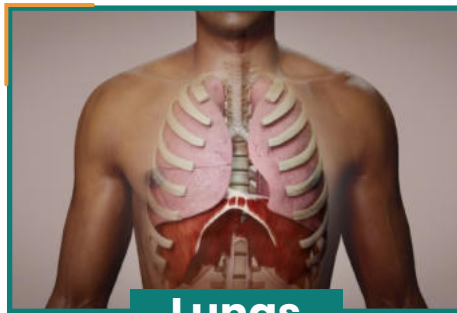
- Fish breathe with gills.
- Plants breathe through tiny holes in their leaves called stomata.
- Humans breathe with their lungs.



Gills



Stomata



Lungs



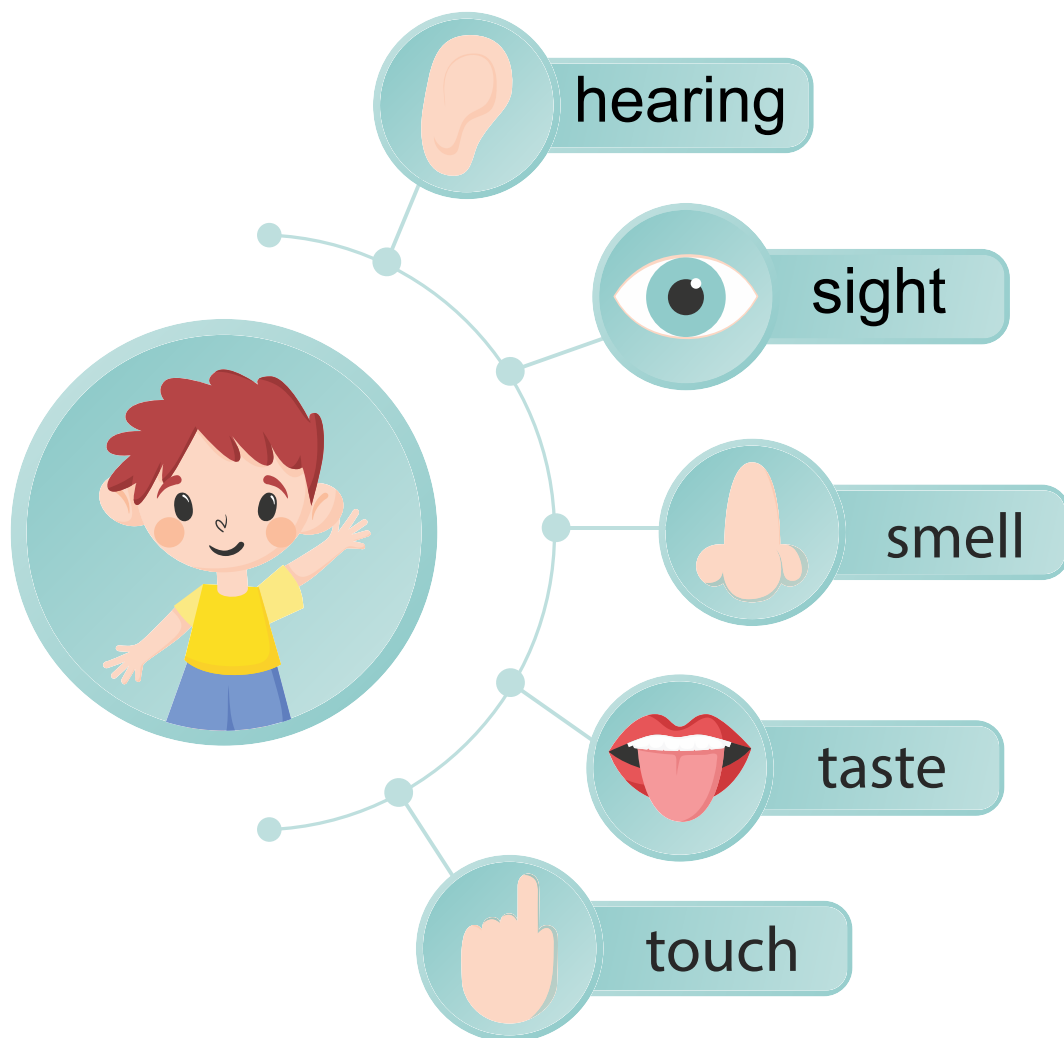
Critical Thinking

What do you think will happen to a plant if we forget to give it water for many days?



5) All Living Things Have Senses:

All living things react to changes around them. Plants can also feel changes, like how sunflower turns toward the Sun. Humans and animals use their five senses: sight, hearing, taste, touch, and smell to understand and interact with their surroundings. Five senses organs of humans are: eyes, ear, nose, tongue, and skin.

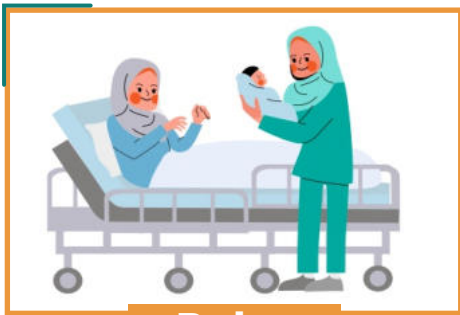


6) All living things reproduce:

All living things, like humans, animals, and plants, make more of their own kind. This is called **reproduction**.

Examples:

- A **human** gives birth to babies.
- A **cat** gives birth to kittens.
- A **hen** lays eggs, and chicks hatch from them.
- A **plant** grows new plants from seeds.



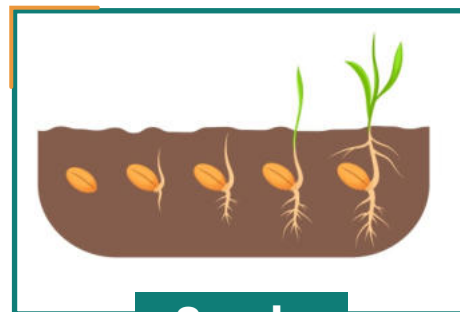
Baby



Kittens



Chicks



Seeds

DO YOU KNOW?

The things which do not have life are called non-living things.

Examples:

stone, brick, plastic, soil.



Differences Between Living Things and Non-living Things

Living Things	Non-living Things
Living things can move.	Non-living things like chair, house, cannot move on their own.
Living things can grow.	Non-living things cannot grow.
Living things can breathe.	Non-living things cannot breathe.
Living things need food and water.	Non-living things do not require any food and water
Living things can reproduce.	Non-living things cannot reproduce.
All living things have senses.	Non-living things do not have senses.

SCAN ME



Test Your Understanding

Q1: What are living things? Give any five examples.

Ans: _____

Q2: Write any three characteristics of living things?

Ans: _____

Q3: How do plants make their own food?

Ans: _____





Q4: Why do animals move from one place to another?

Ans: _____

Q5: What are the five senses, and their functions?

Ans: _____

Q6: How can you tell if something is non-living?

Ans: _____



Fill in the blanks.

1. Living things need _____ and _____ to survive.
2. Plants make their own food using _____, _____, and _____.
3. _____ use their five senses to interact with their surroundings.
4. Humans breathe with their _____, fish breathe with _____, and plants breathe through _____.
5. A butterfly moves with the help of _____.
6. Non-living things do not have _____ or _____.

DO YOU KNOW?

Cheetahs are the fastest land animals.



Tick (✓) for True and cross (x) for False statements.

1. Plants do not need water to grow. ()

2. All living things can move, grow, and reproduce. ()

3. Humans can survive without breathing. ()

4. A stone is a living thing. ()

5. All animals and humans get their food from plants

and other animals. ()

6. A sunflower moves by turning towards the sun. ()



Choose the correct answer:

1. What would happen if we stop watering a plant?

- a) It will dry and die
- b) It will grow faster
- c) It will start moving

2. Why do living things need food?

- a) To look beautiful
- b) To stay in one place
- c) To get energy and survive

3. How do we know something is a living thing?

- a) It can change colour
- b) It can breathe, grow, and move
- c) It can shine in the dark

4. Why do fish have gills instead of lungs?

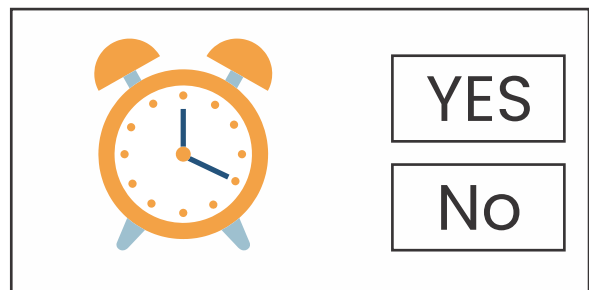
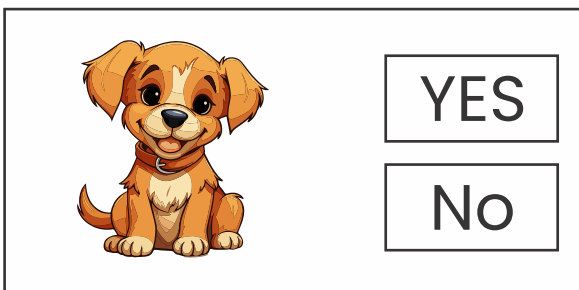
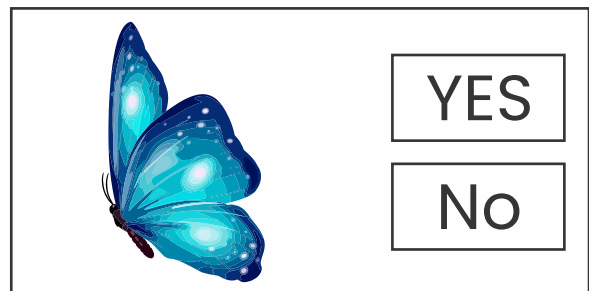
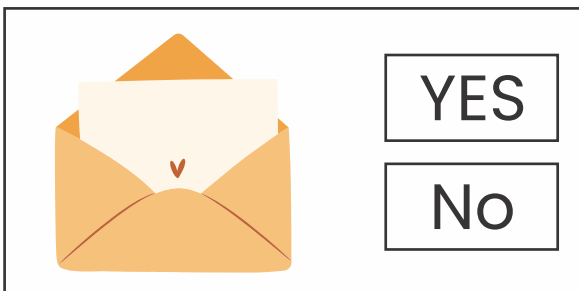
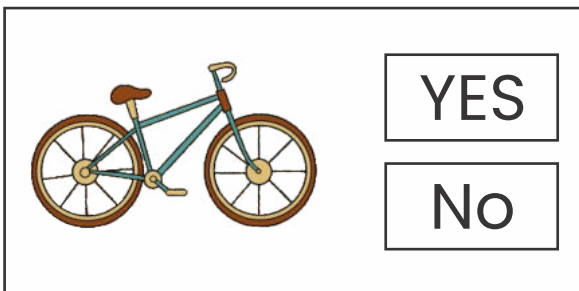
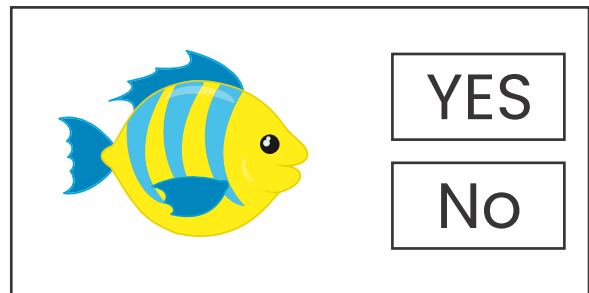
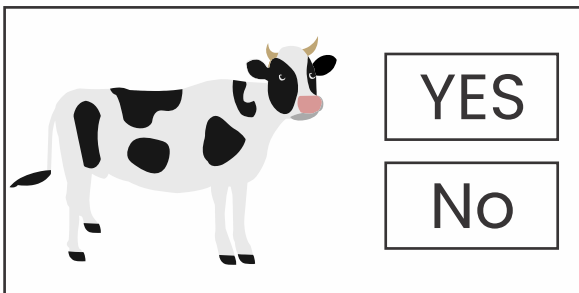
- a) To breathe underwater
- b) To keep them warm
- c) Because they swim

5. Which of the following is a characteristic of a living thing?

- a) Being made of plastic
- b) Sitting still forever
- c) Breathing



Look at each picture. Circle "Yes" if it is a living thing and "No" if it is not.

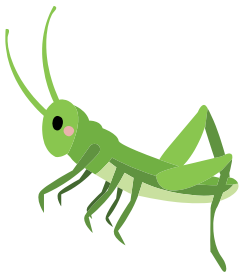


Complete this checklist to find out if the following things are living or not.

	Do I need food and water?	Do I grow?	Do I make babies?	Am I Alive Yes or No?
				
				
				
				



Write the names of living or non-living things into the boxes with the help of the given words.



Tiger	Rose	Pen
Chair	Eagle	Grasshopper





Role-Play Of Living Things



ACTIVITY

Explore how birds, insects, and plants move, eat, and use their senses through a fun role-play!

Instructions:

Choose to be a bird, insect, or plant, and act out how they interact with their environment.

For Birds:

Movement: Flap your arms like wings to show how a birds flies through the air.

Eating: Pretend to peck the ground or use your beak to eat worms, seeds, or insects.

Senses: Show how a bird uses its sharp eyes to look around and spot food from far away.

